

Bring This To Your Doctor, Sodium Corner

You have started draining the sodium corner of your blood pressure. This page helps you have a better conversation at your next visit. Bring it with you. It is a way to share what you are doing and to ask good questions, so you and your doctor read your numbers together. It is not instructions for your doctor, and nothing here is a reason to change a medication on your own.

THE READINGS I AM BRINGING

Write in a few of your recent home readings (date, time, and the number).

The lifestyle changes I have started

- Cut hidden sodium (deli meat, canned soup, frozen meals, jarred sauces, salty snacks)
- Cooking from whole ingredients and seasoning with herbs instead of salt
- Drinking my body weight in pounds as ounces of water each day, water only
- Eating potassium-rich plants at every meal (greens, sweet potato, beans, avocado)
- Added vascular supports: hibiscus tea, raw garlic, a little cayenne, magnesium

Herbs and supplements I have added: Hibiscus tea, raw garlic, cayenne, and magnesium, added one or two at a time and with food.

Important: if you have told me I have kidney disease or heart failure, I am following the sodium, potassium, and fluid targets you set for me, over any general guidance.

Questions to ask about my numbers

- Looking at the readings I brought, how do my numbers look to you?
- What blood pressure range would you like me to aim for?
- How often would you like me to check at home, and at what time of day?
- Are there any readings that should prompt me to call you?

Questions to ask about my current medication

- Here are the readings I have been logging. Would you review them with me?
- I am eating more potassium-rich foods and using garlic and hibiscus. Are any of these a concern alongside my current medication, especially any water pill or potassium-affecting medication?
- As my numbers change, is there anything you would like to watch in my current medication?
- If my readings keep improving, what would you want to see before we discuss any medication change, and how would you want to approach it?
- Is there any sign or symptom I should report to you between visits?